

Is AI Music Losing Its Groove? Kids Are Hitting 'Skip'

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Have you ever heard a song and thought, "Wait, was that made by a robot?" You're not alone! A brand-new report says music fans are getting more and more uncomfortable with songs created by **artificial intelligence**, or AI. And guess what? Young listeners like you are leading the way in saying "no thanks."

The study, from a company called Luminate, found that people feel more negative than positive about AI music. That's especially true for **Gen Z** and **Gen Alpha** that's kids and teens your age! Audrey Schomer, who wrote the report, says many people changed their minds from liking AI music to disliking it in just a few months.

Why? Well, AI songs are everywhere. The music service **Deezer** says 44% of songs uploaded every day are now made by AI. But here's the funny part: those AI songs get less than 3% of actual listens. Most of the plays come from **bots**, not real people. It's like a party where the DJ is a robot and nobody is dancing!

Real musicians are worried too. They say AI songs steal money from artists because streaming services pay based on how many times songs are played. If **bots** play AI songs, real artists get less. Some singers, like SZA, are really upset. She says AI is making weird, fake versions of Black music that feel like **stereotypes**.

Taylor Swift even filed legal papers to protect her voice from being copied by AI. And here's a twist: some AI-made singers, like Xania Monet, have actually signed big record deals! So the beat goes on, but the crowd might be getting quieter.

Word Treasure

artificial intelligence -- Computer programs that can learn and create things like music, sometimes without a human.

Gen Z -- The generation of people born between about 1997 and 2012.

Gen Alpha -- The generation of people born after 2013, still kids and teenagers today.

Deezer -- A music streaming service where you can listen to millions of songs online.

bots -- Short for robots--in this case, computer programs that automatically play songs without a real person listening.

stereotypes -- Oversimplified, often unfair ideas about a group of people.

Background you need

AI, or artificial intelligence, can now write songs by studying thousands of existing tracks. Streaming services like Deezer and Spotify use computers to count plays and pay artists. Many real musicians, including Taylor Swift (one of the world's biggest pop stars) and SZA (a popular R&B singer), have spoken out against AI-generated music because it can copy their voices without permission.

Break it down

WHO: Music fans, especially young people from Gen Z and Gen Alpha, are leading the shift away from AI-made songs.

WHAT: A Luminate report found that people feel more negative than positive about AI music, and that AI tracks get very few real listens.

WHERE: On streaming services like Deezer, where 44% of daily uploads are now AI-generated.

WHY: Real artists are concerned because AI songs, often played by bots, take money away from human musicians and can create unfair stereotypes.

Why it matters

When you listen to your favorite songs, you're also supporting the artists who make them--if AI takes over, your real favorite singers might lose their jobs.

Test what you remember

1. According to the report, how do most people feel about AI-made music?
 - (A) Very positive
 - (B) More negative than positive
 - (C) Completely neutral
 - (D) They have never heard of it
2. What percentage of songs uploaded to Deezer every day are AI-created?
 - (A) 3%
 - (B) 23%
 - (C) 44%
 - (D) 98%
3. The article says most of the plays on AI songs come from:
 - (A) Kids like you
 - (B) Real music fans
 - (C) Bots
 - (D) The artists themselves
4. Which singer mentioned in the article is upset about AI creating fake, stereotypical versions of Black music?
 - (A) Taylor Swift
 - (B) Audrey Schomer
 - (C) SZA
 - (D) Xania Monet
5. What did Taylor Swift do to protect her voice from AI?
 - (A) She asked fans to stop listening
 - (B) She filed legal papers
 - (C) She quit streaming services
 - (D) She made her own AI music
6. What surprising thing happened with AI-made singer Xania Monet?
 - (A) She won a Grammy
 - (B) She signed a big record deal
 - (C) She replaced a human artist at a concert
 - (D) She was banned from streaming

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: C 3: C 4: C 5: B 6: B

Questions to think about

1. Excited about AI's creative potential: Some people think AI can help create amazing new sounds and let more people make music easily.
2. Worried about fairness for artists: Many musicians say AI songs cheat them out of money and often copy real songs without permission.
3. Looking for balance: Music fans and companies are starting to ask for rules that make it clear when a song is made by AI, so listeners can choose.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):